

Summary of Cardiorespiratory Programming Methods

Stage Training Zone	Talk Test	RPE 1–10	RPE 6–20	Example Heart Rate**	Description
Zone 1	Below VT1	3–4	12–13	<142 bpm	• Light to moderate • Sweating begins • Conversation is easy
Zone 2	VT1 to midpoint*	5–7	14–15	142–159 bpm	• Challenging too hard • Sweating • Noticeable breathing • Continual conversation becomes challenging
Zone 3	Midpoint to VT2	7–8	16–17	160–175 bpm	• Vigorous to very hard • Heavy sweating • Hard breathing • Ability to talk is limited to short phrases
Zone 4	Above VT2	9–10	18–20	>175	• Very hard to maximal effort • Breathing as hard as possible • Speaking limited to single words or not possible

*Midpoint: The intensity level halfway between VT1 and VT2.

**Example heart rate as a percentage of VT1 and VT2 uses the VT1 and VT2 test of a 20-year-old female soccer player.